abusing Faf about the run out. Faf shoved him away and was immediately surrounded by a posse of animated, swearing New Zealanders. It was ugly and unnecessary. It felt as though the world had gone crazy in every possible way and, amid the chaos, our dreams were fading.

We had been reduced to 121 for five. The New Zealanders were buzzing, bowling and fielding brilliantly, and we were eventually dismissed for 172, defeated by 49 runs, eliminated from the World Cup we had believed we could win, left to confirm our early flights home, universally condemned as 'chokers', again.

'When the team gets off the plane back home,' Graeme said, 'daggers and stones will be thrown.'

Some, but not all, of the wounds healed in the seven months that elapsed between the Disaster in Dhaka and the arrival of the Australian squad to tour South Africa in October 2011.

Gary Kirsten was appointed to succeed Corrie van Zyl as Proteas coach and I was asked to take over as captain of the national side in limited-overs cricket, with Graeme continuing to lead the Test team. I knew I had a lot to learn, and I recognised I had been chosen primarily because of my performances as a player, but I was determined to embrace the challenge.

The 'new era' suffered an unfortunate false start when I sustained a broken finger during fielding practice with Royal Challengers Bangalore at the Champions League T20 tournament, and was ruled out of the T20 series against the Australians, which was shared, and the three-match ODI series, which we lost 1–2.

Two epic Test matches followed.

In Cape Town, Australia batted first on what seemed a reasonable wicket at Newlands and scored 284, including an extraordinary innings of 151 by Michael Clarke, their captain. Graeme and Jacques Rudolph launched our reply reasonably well, but we proceeded to collapse in the most spectacular and embarrassing fashion, from 49 for one to 96 all out